

Word family: ****independent / independently / independence / independence****

****Base word:** independent**

****Related forms:** independently, independence**

****Part of speech:** adjective (形容詞) / noun in some uses (名詞 , 部分語境) / related adverb and noun forms (相關副詞及名詞)**

Your sentence:

> "...I was trying to become more disciplined and ****independent****."

Meaning in this passage

Here, ****independent**** means ****able to manage your own life, decisions, responsibilities, and actions without relying too much on other people****.

****繁體中文 : ** **獨立的 ; 能自己作決定、處理事情和承擔責任 , 不過度依賴別人的****

****中文翻譯 : ****

> "...I was trying to become more disciplined and ****independent****."

「.....我當時正努力讓自己變得更自律、更****獨立****。」

Here:

****independent = 能靠自己處理生活、學習和決定 , 而不是經常依賴別人****

1. ****independent = able to manage without relying on others (個人) — 獨立的 ; 自主的****

This is the meaning used in your passage.

****Meaning:**** Able to make decisions, solve problems, manage responsibilities, or live without depending heavily on other people.

Practice 1 — Original

> "I wanted to become more ****independent****."

「我想變得更加****獨立****。」

Practice 2

> "She became financially ****independent**** in her twenties."

「她二十多歲時已經做到經濟**獨立**。」

Practice 3

> “Children gradually learn to be more **independent**.”

「孩子會逐漸學會更加**獨立自主**。」

independent = 有能力自己處理事情、作決定和承擔責任，而不需要經常依靠別人

Common:

- * become independent
- * financially independent
- * independent adult
- * independent learner
- * live independently

2. **independent = not controlled by another organization/person (自主) — 獨立自主的；不受控制的**

Independent can mean not controlled, owned, directed, or governed by another person, organization, company, or authority.

Practice 4

> “The newspaper is politically **independent**.”

「這家報紙在政治立場和管理上保持**獨立自主**。」

Practice 5

> “The organization is fully **independent** of the government.”

「這個組織完全**獨立於**政府。」

independent = 不受另一個機構、權力或個人控制或支配的

Common:

- * independent organization
- * independent body
- * independent media

* independent of government

This is a major distinct institutional sense.

3. **independent = separate and self-governing as a country/state (國家) — 獨立的；自主國家的**

A country or territory can be **independent** when it governs itself rather than being controlled by another state.

Practice 6

> “The country became **independent** in the twentieth century.”

「這個國家在二十世紀取得**獨立**。」

Practice 7

> “They wanted to establish an **independent** state.”

「他們希望建立一個**獨立國家**。」

independent = 擁有自身政府和政治主權，不受其他國家統治的

This is a specialized political/state branch of Meaning 2.

4. **independent = separate from something else / not dependent on it (相互關係) — 獨立於……的；不受……影響的**

Independent can mean that one thing exists, happens, or is determined separately from another.

Practice 8

> “The two systems operate **independently**.”

「這兩個系統彼此**獨立運作**。」

Practice 9

> “The result is **independent of** age.”

「這個結果**不受年齡影響 / 與年齡無關**。」

****independent of something = 不依賴、不取決於、不受某事物影響****

This is a major abstract/logical sense.

5. ****independent = objective / unbiased because not involved (判斷 / 調查) — 獨立的 ; 客觀的****

****Independent**** can describe an investigation, review, expert, assessor, etc. who is not connected to the parties involved and is therefore expected to be impartial.

Practice 10

> “The case was reviewed by an ****independent**** expert.”

「案件由一位****獨立 / 客觀的****專家審查。」

Practice 11

> “They called for an ****independent**** investigation.”

「他們要求進行一項****獨立調查****。」

****independent = 與涉事一方沒有直接利益關係，因此能較客觀、公正地作出判斷的****

This is a major modern institutional use.

6. ****independent = not part of a large company/chain (商業) — 獨立經營的 ; 非連鎖的****

A business can be ****independent**** if it is privately owned and not part of a large chain or corporation.

Practice 12

> “The street is full of ****independent**** shops.”

「這條街有很多****獨立經營的小店****。」

Practice 13

> “She works for an ****independent**** publisher.”

「她在一家**獨立出版社**工作。」

independent = 不隸屬大型連鎖集團、公司或母機構，自行經營的

Common:

- * independent shop
- * independent bookstore
- * independent publisher
- * independent cinema

This is a well-established business sense.

7. **independent = produced outside a major commercial system (媒體 / 藝術) — 獨立製作的**

In film, music, publishing, games, etc., **independent** can describe work made outside major commercial studios, labels, or corporations.

Practice 14

> “The film was made by an **independent** studio.”

「這部電影由一家**獨立製作公司**製作。」

Practice 15

> “She releases music through an **independent** label.”

「她透過一家**獨立唱片公司**發行音樂。」

This is related to Meaning 6 and does not need a separate core count.

8. **independent = self-employed / freelance (工作) — 自僱的；獨立工作的**

In some professional contexts, **independent** can mean working for yourself rather than as a regular employee of one organization.

Practice 16

> “He works as an **independent** consultant.”

「他是一名**獨立顧問 / 自僱顧問**。」

Practice 17

> “She became an **independent** contractor.”

「她成為一名**獨立承包商**。」

independent = 不受單一僱主直接聘用，而自行承接工作的

This is an established employment/business use.

9. **independent = not influenced by another variable/event (數學 / 統計) — 獨立的**

In probability and statistics, two events or variables are **independent** if one does not affect the probability or value of the other.

Practice 18

> “The two events are statistically **independent**.”

「這兩個事件在統計上是**獨立的**。」

Practice 19

> “The variables are assumed to be **independent**.”

「這些變數被假設為彼此**獨立**。」

independent = 一個變數 / 事件的結果不會影響另一個的統計結果

This is a genuine specialist branch.

10. **independent = capable of functioning separately (系統 / 部件) — 可獨立運作的**

Machines, systems, components, units, etc. can be **independent** if each can function separately.

Practice 20

> “Each unit has an **independent** power supply.”

「每個單元都有**獨立的**電源供應。」

Practice 21

> “The two departments operate as **independent** units.”

「這兩個部門以**獨立單位**形式運作。」

For strict counting, this belongs under Meaning 4.

Related form: **independently**

****Independently**** means without depending on or being controlled by others.

Practice 22

> “She can work **independently**.”

「她可以**獨立工作**。」

Practice 23

> “The two researchers reached the same conclusion **independently**.”

「兩位研究人員**各自獨立地**得出了相同結論。」

****independently** = 不依靠別人；不受其他因素控制；各自地

Related form: ****independence****

****Independence**** is the noun form.

**personal independence — 個人獨立**

Practice 24

> “Moving away from home gave him greater ****independence****.”

「搬離家中讓他獲得更大的****獨立自主****。」

**political independence — 國家獨立**

Practice 25

> “The country declared **independence**.”

「這個國家宣布**獨立**。」

organizational independence — 機構自主

Practice 26

> “The regulator’s **independence** is important.”

「監管機構的**獨立性**很重要。」

Important distinction: **independent vs alone**

alone

means without other people present.

independent

means capable of functioning or making decisions without relying heavily on others.

Someone can live with family but still be highly independent.

And someone can be alone while still depending heavily on others financially or practically.

Important distinction: **independent vs self-reliant**

self-reliant

strongly emphasizes relying on your own abilities and resources.

independent

is broader and can refer to:

- * personal autonomy
- * institutions
- * countries

* businesses

* variables

For people, they often overlap.

Important distinction: **independent vs autonomous**

autonomous

means having the authority or capacity to govern/control oneself.

independent

means not dependent on or controlled by another.

Autonomous is usually more formal and often institutional/technical.

> autonomous region

> independent country

Important distinction: **independent vs separate**

separate

simply means not joined or together.

independent

means able to exist, function, or be determined without reliance on another thing.

> separate rooms

> independent systems

Two things can be separate but still dependent on each other.

Important distinction: **independent vs neutral**

neutral

means not supporting either side.

independent

means not controlled by either side.

An independent reviewer may also be neutral, but the concepts are not identical.

Important distinction: **independent vs unbiased**

unbiased

specifically means not unfairly influenced by personal preferences or interests.

independent

means structurally separate from interested parties.

Independence can help produce unbiased judgment, but it does not automatically guarantee it.

Important distinction: **independent vs freelance**

freelance

usually means working for different clients without long-term employment by one employer.

independent

is broader.

> independent consultant

> freelance designer

Often overlap, but not always.

Grammar note: **independent of**

The standard construction is:

> **independent of something**

Examples:

- > independent of government
- > independent of income
- > independent of each other

Not normally:

- > independent from something

****Independent from**** does occur, but ****independent of**** is the safest and most standard general pattern.

Countability note

****Independent**** is mainly an adjective.

As a noun, ****an independent**** can refer to someone who is unaffiliated with a larger organization or group in certain contexts.

For example:

- > “The shop is owned by an independent.”

or in other institutional contexts, someone acting without formal affiliation.

These noun uses are more context-dependent, so I would keep them secondary rather than core.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * ****independent****
- * ****independently****
- * ****independence****

Useful compounds and extensions include:

- * financially independent
- * independent learner
- * independent organization
- * independent investigation

- * independent business
- * independent contractor
- * independent variable
- * independent media

The word is semantically broad, but many uses share the central concept:

> ****not relying on / not controlled by something else****

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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independent — person	能自己作決定、處理事情和承擔責任，不過度依賴別人的
independent — organization/institution	不受另一個機構、權力或個人控制的
independent — country/state	具有自身政治主權、不受其他國家統治的
independent of something	不依賴、不取決於或不受某因素影響的
independent — review/expert	與涉事方沒有直接利益關係，因此能較客觀地作判斷的
independent — business/media	不隸屬大型連鎖、母公司或主要商業集團而自行經營 / 製作的
independent — contractor/professional	不作為單一機構固定僱員，而自行承接工作的
independent — statistics	一個事件或變數的結果不會影響另一個
independently	獨立地；不依靠別人；各自地
independence	獨立、自主、不受控制或依賴的狀態

For your original sentence

> “...I was trying to become more disciplined and ****independent****.”

The exact meaning is:

****independent = 能更好地自己管理生活、學習和決定，而不是經常依賴別人的幫助或監督****

So:

> ****become more independent****

= ****變得更加獨立自主****

For your database, I would count ****6 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****independent****:

1. ****personally self-reliant/autonomous****
2. ****not controlled by another organization/person****

3. **politically self-governing / sovereign**
4. **not dependent on or affected by another factor**
5. **impartial because structurally separate from interested parties**
6. **commercial/professional: not part of a larger organization or employer**

I would keep statistical independence as a specialist extension of #4, merge independent shops/media/contractors under #6 where appropriate, and keep **independently / independence** as family extensions rather than inflate the adjective count.